MONTHLY UPDATE

Morocco: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
Legislation and regulation · Data protection · Regional collaboration · Public debate and participation in policymaking

FINANCE
MoUs and other agreements · New investments

ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
Data Storage

DPI
Digital Payments and Fintech · Other GovTech and e-Gov

TECHNOLOGY
AI · Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY
Training and skills · Research institutions

INCLUSION
Access to services · Digital divides

Governance

Legislation and regulation

CIVIL PROCEDURE CODE REQUIREMENT OF AN EMAIL ADDRESS FOR LEGAL-PERSON PARTIES

- **غياب البريد الإلكتروني يعرقل مساطر تحصيل الديون أمام المحاكم التجارية** — Hespress, 13 October 2026

  Casablanca court refuses MAD 376,552 claim under Civil Procedure Code Article 234; email now mandatory for companies.

Data protection

JUDICIAL INVESTIGATION INTO CLAIMED SPYING ON A POLITICAL PARTY'S PHONES

- **النيابة العامة بالدار البيضاء تفتح بحثا قضائيا بشأن ادعاءات التجسس على هواتف حزب سياسي** — Nichan, 14 September 2026

  Morocco's prosecutor general at the Casablanca Court of Appeal ordered a judicial investigation into a party leader's claim that his party's phones were being spied on. The national judicial police will verify the claim, which the prosecution tied to the proper conduct of the elections; the party is not named.

Regional collaboration

ESCWA MEMORANDUM ON DIGITAL GOVERNANCE

- **ESCWA and Morocco Sign Regional Partnership to Advance Digital Governance** — Tech Africa News, 3 September 2026

  The UN Economic and Social Commission for Western Asia and Morocco's minister for digital transition signed a memorandum in Rabat framing regional cooperation on modernising public administration and digital governance reform.

Public debate and participation in policymaking

TACIT-APPROVAL PROPOSAL FOR ADMINISTRATIVE DECISIONS

- **La petite révolution administrative cachée dans le programme de l'Istiqlal** — L'ODJ, 4 September 2026

  Istiqlal manifesto's tacit-approval rule, fewer prior authorisations, AI in public-policy governance.

PUBLIC ARGUMENT OVER THE SPYWARE ALLEGATIONS

- **حداد يفند مزاعم اختراق المغرب لهاتف سانشيز** — Assabah, 8 September 2026

  A Moroccan academic and politician rejected as overstated the July 2026 consortium findings tying Moroccan bodies to the compromise of the Spanish prime minister’s phone.

- **من 'تصفية المنظري' إلى 'بيغاسوس'.. هل يفتح القضاء الإسباني ملف حيجاوي؟** — Hespress, 8 September 2026

  A Moroccan analysis asks why Spanish prosecutors have taken no action against a former intelligence officer since 2010, and whether the spyware row now reopens that file.

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

DIGITAL INFRASTRUCTURE AND CLOUD MEMORANDUM

- **Rabat : signature d’un MoU pour accélérer le développement des infrastructures numériques et du cloud** — PanoraPost, 15 September 2026

  The digital transition ministry and a critical digital-infrastructure supplier signed a memorandum in Rabat on developing digital infrastructure, cloud computing and artificial intelligence.

New investments

INSURANCE TECHNOLOGY AND INCLUSION PROGRAMME

- **InsurTech in Morocco: AfDB backs a programme to modernise insurance** — Canal212, 27 September 2026

  US$680,000 package: AfDB ADFI grant US$510,000, ACAPS US$170,000; sandbox mooted, roadshow Q1 2027.

DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION ACCELERATION PROGRAM

- **Numérique et climat : le Maroc consolide deux chantiers de long terme avec 567,3 M€** — La Vérité, 4 October 2026

  BO n°7548 decrees approve EUR 218.2m digital loan signed 25 June and EUR 349.1m climate-risk loan.

ICT Infrastructure

Data Storage

ICUDAR DAKHLA GREEN DATA CENTRE

- **Maroc IA 2030 : le Royaume passe de l'ambition a l'action** — LesEco.ma, 10 September 2026

> Dakhla 100ha/500MW green data-centre campus, ~1GW national target, darija and amazigh sovereign LLM.

> NEXUS ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE COMPUTE PLATFORM

- **FiveNines Group partners with Nexus Core Systems to develop 20MW data centre in Morocco** — EIN Presswire (FiveNines Group announcement), 7 October 2026

  UK firm to design 20MW high-density AI facility on Nvidia Vera Rubin reference; platform target put at 180MW.

DPI

Digital Payments and Fintech

> MEMORANDUM WITH THE UAE CENTRAL BANK ON INTERLINKING PAYMENT SYSTEMS

- **CBUAE, Bank Al-Maghrib sign two MoUs to strengthen supervisory cooperation, Islamic finance** — Eye of Riyadh, 4 October 2026

  Bank Al-Maghrib and the Central Bank of the UAE signed two memoranda in Abu Dhabi. One covers supervisory information exchange and Islamic finance; the other is to explore linking the two countries' instant payment platforms, card switches and financial messaging systems, and to exchange expertise on central bank digital currencies.

> RETAIL CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY (RESEARCH AND PROOF OF CONCEPT)

- **A DSGE Model for a Small Open Economy with a CBDC Option (Bank Al-Maghrib Working Paper)** — Bank Al-Maghrib, 7 October 2026

  Bank Al-Maghrib DSGE model calibrated on Morocco finds a retail CBDC brings modest output and shock-resilience gains.

- **Monnaie Digitale de Banque Centrale : Enjeux et enseignements pour le Maroc (Document de travail)** — Bank Al-Maghrib, 7 October 2026

  Bank Al-Maghrib working paper on central bank digital currency designs, impacts and lessons for Morocco.

- **بنك المغرب يصدر وثيقتي عمل حول العملة الرقمية للبنك المركزي** — Assabah, 9 October 2026

  Morocco's central bank published two research working papers on a central bank digital currency, one on the stakes and lessons for Morocco and one a modelling exercise. It presents them as its researchers' work, shared for debate.

> CASH IN CIRCULATION AND CARD USE

- **زحف "الكاش" يمتحن نجاعة خطط "بنك المغرب" لتوسيع الأداء الرقمي** — Hespress, 13 October 2026

  Cash in circulation MAD 550.3bn at end-August 2026, up 12.1% in eight months; withdrawals 85% of card value in 2025.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

> ELECTRONIC FILING OF ELECTION CANDIDACIES

- **انتخاب أعضاء مجلس النواب.. إيداع التصريحات بالترشيح إلى غاية 9 شتنبر (بلاغ للداخلية)** — Assabah, 4 September 2026

  Interior Ministry makes elections.ma e-filing mandatory for 23 Sep 2026 legislative candidacies; portal shuts 8 Sep noon.

> IDARATI NATIONAL PORTAL, NEW VERSION

- **Idarati : vers une administration plus proche, proactive et centrée sur le citoyen** — Ministère de la Transition Numérique et de la Réforme de l'Administration (MTNRA), 18 September 2026

  The Moroccan digital transition ministry's own communiqué on the relaunched Idarati portal presents it as a proactive, user-centred single access point to administrations' digital services.

- **Lancement de la nouvelle version du portail national Idarati, pour une administration plus proche et plus intelligente** — Assahafa, 18 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry launched a new version of the Idarati portal, giving access to 874 online services organised around user journeys and 2,533 published administrative acts, with a feedback function, an accessibility redesign and a marketplace of AI solutions. The ministry presents it as groundwork for Idarati X.0.

Technology

AI

AI MADE IN MOROCCO ROADMAP

- **Madame Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni a preside, le 8 septembre 2026 a Rabat, une presentation consacree a l'etat actuel de la feuille de route 'Maroc pour l'intelligence artificielle 2030'** — Ministere de la Transition Numerique et de la Reforme de l'Administration, 8 September 2026

  MAD 100bn GDP value-add, 50,000 jobs, 200,000 certified talents by 2030; Data Factory and sovereign cloud.

- **IA : le Maroc engage une nouvelle phase de sa strategie nationale a l'horizon 2030** — PanoraPost, 9 September 2026

  Sovereign AI marketplace, Idarati AI assistant, a national e-wallet POC, and a Livre Rose on digital sovereignty.

- **Maroc IA 2030 : le Royaume passe de l'ambition a l'action** — LesEco.ma, 10 September 2026

  Summarised under Data Storage.

JAZARI ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE INSTITUTES

- **Les assemblees generales de quatre Instituts 'JAZARI' se sont tenues le 8 septembre 2026 a Rabat, sous la presidence de Madame la Ministre Amal El Fallah Seghrouchni** — Ministere de la Transition Numerique et de la Reforme de l'Administration, 8 September 2026

  Four JAZARI institutes move to operations after August 2026 Bulletin officiel approval of their conventions.

NATIONAL ARTIFICIAL-INTELLIGENCE ROADMAP "MOROCCO AI 2030"

- **Les principales avancees de la feuille de route Maroc IA 2030 presentees a Rabat** — Maroc.ma (Portail national du Maroc) / MAP, 8 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry presented the main advances of the Maroc IA 2030 roadmap in Rabat, framing it as the move from design into implementation. The minister-delegate said the national AI conference had been the founding stage and that the AI Made in Morocco roadmap now enters a phase of concrete delivery.

RAIL OPERATOR'S NATIONAL AI VIDEO-SURVEILLANCE SYSTEM

- **ONCF prépare un dispositif national de vidéosurveillance dopé à l'IA pour 2030** — Journal Du Canada, 10 September 2026

  MAD 1.08m design study for AI video surveillance across the rail network; no deployment budget set yet.

DIGITAL MINISTRY PARTNERSHIP WITH MISTRAL AI

- **Morocco, Mistral AI release first open-source AI tools under AI made in Morocco roadmap** — Tech Review Africa, 29 September 2026

  Morocco's digital ministry and Mistral AI released their first open-source tools: a classifier that tells Arabic dialects including Darija apart, and a speech-recognition model for Darija that handles switching into French and English.

- **Le ministère de la Transition numérique et Mistral annoncent les premières briques d'IA développées | Maroc.ma** — Maroc.ma (Government of Morocco), 30 September 2026

  Morocco's digital transition ministry and Mistral released the first open-source tools from their AI partnership: a classifier that distinguishes Arabic dialects including Darija, and a Voxtral speech-recognition model for Darija that handles switching between Arabic, French and English. The ministry says further language and public-service models are in development.

Innovation ecosystem

FONDS CATALYTIQUE STARTUPS

- **Feu vert a Tamwilcom pour investir 347 MDH dans les startups** — Entreprises du Maroc, 10 September 2026

  Decret 2.26.576 caps Tamwilcom's Fonds Catalytique Startups stakes at MAD 347m over three years.

- **Digital : 347 millions de dirhams en appui au financement des startups au Maroc (ministere)** — H24Info, 11 September 2026

  Ministry communique adds the Economy and Finance Ministry to the 21 November 2025 convention behind the 347 MDH fund.

- **Morocco targets $258 million in startup financing through new venture capital mechanism** — The Morocco Post, 14 September 2026

  Decree 2.26.576 of 2026-08-03 opens a Startup Catalytic Fund targeting about US$258m, US$36m public over three years.

Capacity

Training and skills

GÉNÉRATION AIOT TRAINING PROGRAMME

- **Le programme Génération AIoT vise 1 200 talents formés par an dès février 2027** — Consonews, 13 September 2026

  Morocco's Génération AIoT programme opened seven cohorts in Casablanca, Fès and Oujda, aiming at 1,200 trained people a year from February 2027. Launched in February 2026 by the digital transition ministry with a foundation and ABA Technology, it had drawn 2,118 applications and gathered 95 participants.

CIVIL-SERVICE DIGITAL TRAINING PARTNERSHIP (ENA AND ADD)

- **ENA and ADD join forces to make Morocco's government more digital** — 7News Morocco, 23 September 2026

  Signed 22 Sep 2026: civil-servant training in digital transformation, AI, data management, change management.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP PROGRAMME IN CYBERSECURITY

- **"Cyber Academy" Cybersecurity Training Program for African Leaders Kicks off in Rabat** — Maroc.ma (MAP), 6 October 2026 AFRICA

  DGSSI and World Bank course with Smart Africa Digital Academy, 5-8 Oct 2026; AI threats, crisis simulations.

Research institutions

ADAPTVOTE OFFLINE-CAPABLE E-VOTING RESEARCH PROTOTYPE

- **"تجربة مغربية للتصويت الرقمي تجمع التعرف على الوجه و"البلوك تشين"** — Hespress, 7 September 2026

  AdaptVote: 300-person Moroccan field trial of biometric plus blockchain e-voting that keeps working on weak connectivity.

DOMESTIC AI RESEARCH ON CLIMATE ADAPTATION

- **المغرب يوسع أبحاث الذكاء الاصطناعي لمواجهة مخاطر الإجهاد المائي** — Hespress, 10 September 2026

  A scientific review available from 1 September records an expansion of Moroccan research applying artificial intelligence to drought, water scarcity and rising temperatures. It covers forecasting tools, resource monitoring, irrigation, and the management of energy and heat inside cities, across water, agriculture, energy, cities and natural hazards.

Inclusion

Access to services

DISABILITY DATA AND ACCESS MEASURES

- **Morocco disability rate rises to 8.7% as access gaps persist** — Hespress English, 3 September 2026

  8.7% prevalence in 2026 against 6.8% in 2014, and only 20% of disabled Moroccans report internet access.

USE OF AND TRUST IN SOCIAL PLATFORMS

- **86% من المغاربة يستخدمون منصات التواصل و'واتساب' في الصدارة** — Assabah, 4 September 2026

  Sonergia barometer 2026: platform use at 86% of Moroccans, WhatsApp 83%, TikTok 32%; 61% distrust platform news.

Digital divides

NIGHT-TIME NETWORK OUTAGES IN THE BEN CHERRO DOUARS, BENI MELLAL

- **(AR) Phone network cut at night in Ben Cherro douars, Beni Mellal: residents complain of a 'digital isolation' lasting until morning** — Al Omk Al Maghribi, 17 September 2026

  Residents of thirteen douars in the Ben Cherro area of Morocco's Beni Mellal province say phone service cuts out nightly from about 8pm until morning, with internet throughput degraded over the same hours. They describe the consequences as sharpest in emergencies.

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